

E200

MSHRM Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hiring manager with 20 years of experience likes to “get a feel” for candidates through casual conversation. HR wants to reduce bias in hiring. The office has a new open-plan design. Which change would most reduce bias?

- A. Make the conversations even more casual to know candidates better.
- B. Rely on the manager's long experience.
- C. Eliminate interviews entirely.
- D. Use structured interviews with the same job-related questions and a scoring rubric.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An employer hired 48 of 120 applicants from Group A and 18 of 60 applicants from Group B. The recruiter used a new applicant-tracking system. Does the four-fifths rule indicate adverse impact against Group B?

- A. Yes; $30\% \div 40\% = 0.75$, below 0.80.
- B. No; the rates differ by only 10 points.
- C. No; the ratio is 1.33.
- D. Yes, because Group B had fewer hires (18 vs. 48).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Group A's selection rate is 50%. What is the lowest selection rate for Group B that avoids a four-fifths flag?

- A. 80%
- B. 30%
- C. 62.5%
- D. 40%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A software firm's posting for a junior analyst calls for a “rockstar ninja,” requires a master's degree for entry-level work, and describes the company's award-winning cafeteria. Which change most improves inclusiveness?

- A. Require a degree for every role to keep it fair.
- B. Remove the cafeteria description.
- C. Use neutral language and list only essential, job-related requirements.
- D. Add more preferred qualifications to attract top talent.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An HR analyst finds women earn 12% less than men on average company-wide. After controlling for job level, tenure, and performance, the gap in comparable roles is 4%. The company recently won a “best places to work” award. What should the analysis focus on?

- A. Investigate the 4% unexplained gap in comparable roles and correct it where no legitimate factor explains it.
- B. Take no action; the award shows pay is fair.
- C. Treat the 8-point explained portion as proof of discrimination.
- D. Treat the full 12% as discrimination.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A raw gender pay gap is 15%. After controlling for legitimate factors, 11 points are explained. What is the adjusted (unexplained) gap?

- A. 26%
- B. 15%
- C. 4%
- D. 11%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An employee who uses a wheelchair asks for a height-adjustable desk. She is one of the top sellers and has worked at the firm for 6 years. What should HR do first?

- A. Begin an interactive process to understand the need and identify an effective accommodation.
- B. Deny it, because desks are always standardized.
- C. Grant it only because she is a top performer.
- D. Require her full medical records before any discussion.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A requested accommodation would cause undue hardship for the employer. What is the appropriate response?

- A. Grant it anyway, regardless of cost.
- B. Terminate the employee.
- C. Explore alternative accommodations that would work without undue hardship.
- D. Deny the request and close the case.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A company finds employees from underrepresented groups get plenty of advice but are rarely put forward for stretch assignments. The company's development program is branded with a mountain logo. Which intervention targets the gap?

- A. More mentoring sessions.
- B. A sponsorship program where senior leaders advocate for them for stretch roles.
- C. Unconscious-bias training alone.
- D. Rebrand the program with a new logo.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Compared with a sponsor, what does a mentor primarily do?

- A. Conducts the person's formal performance review.
- B. Gives advice and guidance.
- C. Uses influence to push for the person's promotion.
- D. Guarantees the person's advancement.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A firm finds that resumes with certain names get fewer callbacks. The recruiting team has 5 members and uses a shared inbox. Which step directly addresses this at the screening stage?

- A.** Accept only employee referrals.
- B.** Hire more recruiters.
- C.** Diversity training alone guarantees fair screening.
- D.** Remove names and other identifying details during initial resume screening.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A company's workforce met all its representation targets, but exit interviews show underrepresented employees leave at twice the rate and report low belonging. The company's headquarters is LEED-certified. What should the capstone plan measure next?

- A.** Representation only, since targets are met.
- B.** Inclusion outcomes such as belonging scores, promotion rates, and retention by group.
- C.** The building's sustainability rating.
- D.** Total hiring volume.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A hiring manager ~~with 20 years of experience~~ likes to “get a feel” for candidates through casual conversation. HR wants to reduce bias in hiring. ~~The office has a new open-plan design.~~ Which change would most reduce bias?

Target word: bias-reducing interview practice **Decides:** Unstructured interviews invite bias.

A	Inverted operation	Less structure means more room for bias.
B	Camouflage	Experience does not remove bias.
C	Absolute language	Removes useful information instead of improving it.
D	Correct	Consistency and rubrics reduce bias.

2. Answer A Concept 2

An employer hired 48 of 120 applicants from Group A and 18 of 60 applicants from Group B. ~~The recruiter used a new applicant tracking system.~~ Does the four-fifths rule indicate adverse impact against Group B?

Target word: four-fifths test **Decides:** Rates: A = 40%, B = 30%.

A	Correct	B's rate is 75% of A's.
B	Adjacent category	The rule uses a ratio, not a point difference.
C	Inverted operation	Divides A by B instead of B by A.
D	Wrong stem number	Raw counts ignore different applicant pools.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

Group A's selection rate is 50%. What is the lowest selection rate for Group B that avoids a four-fifths flag?

Target word: solve for the threshold **Decides:** $0.80 \times 50\%$.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the ratio, not a selection rate.
B	Confusion set	Subtracts 20 points instead of taking 80%.
C	Inverted operation	Divides by 0.80 instead of multiplying.
D	Correct	$0.80 \times 50\% = 40\%$.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A software firm's posting for a junior analyst calls for a “rockstar ninja,” requires a master's degree for entry-level work, and ~~describes the company's award-winning cafeteria.~~ Which change most improves inclusiveness?

Target word: inclusive posting fix **Decides:** Coded language and inflated requirements.

A	Absolute language	Blanket requirements screen out qualified people.
B	Camouflage	The cafeteria is not what excludes applicants.
C	Correct	Widens the pool without lowering the real bar.
D	Inverted operation	Longer lists discourage qualified applicants.

5. Answer A Concept 4

An HR analyst finds women earn 12% less than men on average company-wide. After controlling for job level, tenure, and performance, the gap in comparable roles is 4%. ~~The company recently won a “best places to work” award.~~ What should the analysis focus on?

Target word: which gap to act on **Decides:** 4% is unexplained by legitimate factors.

A	Correct	The adjusted gap is what pay equity reviews target.
B	Camouflage	An award is not a pay analysis.
C	Confusion set	The explained portion is due to legitimate factors.
D	Dropped element	Drops the legitimate factors controlled for.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A raw gender pay gap is 15%. After controlling for legitimate factors, 11 points are explained. What is the adjusted (unexplained) gap?

Target word: solve for adjusted gap **Decides:** Raw – explained.

A	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the raw gap.
C	Correct	$15 - 11 = 4$ points.
D	Confusion set	That is the explained portion.

7. Answer A Concept 5

An employee who uses a wheelchair asks for a height-adjustable desk. ~~She is one of the top sellers and has worked at the firm for 6 years.~~ What should HR do first?

Target word: first step on an accommodation request **Decides:** A request triggers the interactive process.

A	Correct	The standard first step.
B	Absolute language	Standard policy does not override the duty to accommodate.
C	Camouflage	Performance does not decide eligibility.
D	Adjacent category	Limited documentation may be requested when the need is unclear; full records up front is not the first step.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A requested accommodation would cause undue hardship for the employer. What is the appropriate response?

Target word: response when a request is not feasible **Decides:** Undue hardship shifts the search, not the duty.

A	Absolute language	Undue hardship is a recognized limit.
B	Inverted operation	The opposite of accommodating.
C	Correct	The interactive process continues.
D	Dropped element	Drops the search for alternatives.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A company finds employees from underrepresented groups get plenty of advice but are rarely put forward for stretch assignments. ~~The company's development program is branded with a mountain logo.~~ Which intervention targets the gap?

Target word: right development intervention **Decides:** Advice exists; advocacy is missing.

A	Confusion set	Advice is already plentiful.
B	Correct	Sponsors open doors; mentors advise.
C	Adjacent category	Useful, but does not directly create advocacy.
D	Camouflage	Branding is not the gap.

10. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

Compared with a sponsor, what does a mentor primarily do?

Target word: work backward from role to function **Decides:** Mentor = advice and guidance.

A	Adjacent category	That is the manager's role.
B	Correct	The core mentor role.
C	Inverted operation	That is sponsorship.
D	Absolute language	No role guarantees advancement.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A firm finds that resumes with certain names get fewer callbacks. ~~The recruiting team has 5 members and uses a shared inbox.~~ Which step directly addresses this at the screening stage?

Target word: screening fix **Decides:** Bias is triggered by names.

A	Inverted operation	Referrals tend to replicate existing networks.
B	Camouflage	Team size does not remove the cue.
C	Absolute language	Training alone rarely changes screening outcomes.
D	Correct	Removes the cue that triggers the bias.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A company's workforce met all its representation targets, but exit interviews show underrepresented employees leave at twice the rate and report low belonging. ~~The company's headquarters is LEED-certified.~~ What should the capstone plan measure next?

Target word: next metric **Decides:** Representation is met; inclusion is not.

A	Confusion set	Representation is not inclusion.
B	Correct	These capture whether people can thrive and stay.
C	Camouflage	Unrelated to inclusion.
D	Adjacent category	Hiring more does not fix why people leave.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Structured interviews	Asking every candidate the same job-related questions and scoring with a rubric reduces bias and improves prediction.	Trusting an experienced interviewer's gut feel.	Casual, unscripted interviews.
2	Four-fifths rule	Adverse impact is indicated when one group's selection rate is below 80% of the highest group's rate.	Comparing raw hire counts or percentage-point differences.	Hires and applicants for two groups.
3	Inclusive job postings	Use neutral language and list only essential, job-related requirements.	Inflated credentials or coded language presented as quality.	Jargon and requirements that exceed the role.
4	Pay equity analysis	Compare pay for comparable work after controlling for legitimate factors; the unexplained gap is what needs correction.	Treating the raw gap, or the explained part, as the discrimination measure.	A raw gap and an adjusted gap.
5	Reasonable accommodation	An accommodation request starts an interactive process to identify an effective accommodation; undue hardship leads to exploring alternatives, not closing the door.	Denying outright or demanding full medical records first.	An employee asks for a workplace change tied to a disability.
6	Mentoring vs. sponsorship	Mentors give advice; sponsors use their influence to advocate for opportunities and promotions.	Adding more mentoring when the gap is access to opportunity.	People get advice but are not put forward.
7	Blind screening	Removing names and identifying details at initial screening reduces bias from those cues.	Relying on training alone or on referrals.	Callback differences tied to names.
8	Inclusion vs. representation metrics	Representation counts who is present; inclusion is measured through belonging, advancement, and retention by group.	Stopping at representation targets.	Targets met but people leaving.

Course scope (public description): In the MSHRM Capstone, you will complete a project that demonstrates how to integrate inclusive practices into recruitment, development, rewards, and more. You will also have the opportunity to pursue a SHRM specialty credential that highlights your expertise with inclusion. By the end of the course, you will have both the knowledge and the portfolio to show that you can design workplaces where every employee can contribute and thrive.